

## VIRTUAL REALITY: Get The First Mover Advantage



Virtual reality is being used by brands at their events to engage better with their target audience (Image courtesy: wikimedia.org)

- Virtual reality market in India is forecast to grow at nearly 56 per cent between 2016 and 2021.
- Sectors such as healthcare and military stand to benefit greatly from virtual reality apps.

**V**irtual reality has been around for quite some time now. With every other brand rushing to use virtual reality and augmented reality in its marketing efforts, this market is bound to grow by leaps and bounds. An IDC report estimates the revenues for augmented and virtual reality (AR/VR) market to grow to \$162 billion in 2020. Another report expects the virtual reality market in India to grow at nearly 56 per cent between 2016 and 2021. So where does the opportunity lie in this market? Clearly, virtual reality has

far more to offer than just viewing. And thus, we list down a few business opportunities in this market in India that can be explored by those who wish to rake in the moolah.

### App development

It's a booming business and the key to the market. Developing customised apps for different industries can be a great business opportunity. In particular, sectors such as healthcare and military can really benefit from VR.

In military, VR and AR can be used to train defence forces. The

US-based Imagine Technologies is already developing AR for the Indian army. Its ShootAR augmented reality simulator for soldier training lets soldiers see and interact in an environment that is an amalgamation of both real and virtual worlds.

For instance, soldiers using ShootAR can see virtual terrorist attacks in 3D against the backdrop of real-world surroundings, thus getting equipped to handle a real battle in a better manner. This sector definitely offers some high-revenue business opportunities to VR players